

In 1833, Mendelssohn was appointed municipal music director in Düsseldorf, then two years later he took up the more prestigious post of director of the Gewandhaus Orchestra in Leipzig (see [box](#)). This city was to be his home for the remainder of his life. However, he continued to travel and work elsewhere, organizing festivals in various German cities and also in Birmingham. He was extremely successful as the Gewandhaus's director, raising its standards, improving conditions for its members, and using innovative programming in which the work of past giants, such as Beethoven and Mozart, mixed with contemporary pieces. In 1843, he also founded a conservatory in Leipzig; this became the leading music school in Germany.



*AM AMALFI MAI, 1831*

A talented artist, Mendelssohn made many drawings and watercolors on his travels, including this one of the Amalfi coast in Italy.